

Real-Life Examples

A Relator colleague of mine is someone I'll call Tracey. When we had financial discussions, Tracey told me she's completely overwhelmed by what's happening globally and the natural disasters that are being broadcast so regularly on the news and social media. She finds herself donating and donating until she's scared to look at how much she's actually given and what the balance will be in her bank account. Tracey admits to wanting to enjoy today and 'to hell with tomorrow' because she doesn't know what tomorrow will look like.

To help manage her distress, her innate need to help and her tendency to opt out, Tracey has set up multiple bank accounts and a system of automation to help reduce her spending, which has allowed her to donate with confidence to causes she cares about. She has a holiday account, a giving account, an everyday account and a bills account. It was important to Tracey that a percentage of her income be donated so she also created a bank account and an automation for giving. This meant she felt more relaxed because she had prioritised something she highly valued. Tracey already acknowledges that she'll donate more than what is in the giving account, but by limiting any extra giving to her everyday account she has created her own financial safety net as well. Tracey recognised she couldn't afford to go on an annual overseas holiday and save and give back, so she chose to go on an overseas trip once every three years instead of annually. Tracey also realised she wants the security of her own home and part of delaying gratification with her holiday will allow her to save for a deposit.

Tracey travels with friends and she has in the past helped pay for some of their airfares to ensure the entire group can go away. The group is already planning a holiday in three years' time to South America and Tracey has organised for them to open a joint bank account together that requires all holders' signatures to make any withdrawals. Everyone has automated a regular amount to be transferred to it and they have created a WhatsApp group to encourage each other. They've agreed that if life happens and someone can't go and needs their funds, they'll be refunded the amount they've contributed in full. Some of the group have admitted this 'forced savings' is the first time they'll go on a trip where it hasn't